DESIGN EXPERIENCE

I • II • III

PROJECT REPORT FORMAT

Guidelines & Templates

Common Framework for All Design Experience Verticals

VIP • EPICS • Industry Research • Technical Competition • Entrepreneurship

MPSTME · SVKM's NMIMS, Mumbai

MUKESH PATEL SCHOOL OF TECHNOLOGY, MANAGEMENT & ENGINEERING

SVKM's NMIMS (Deemed-to-be University), Mumbai

ACADEMIC YEAR 2026–27

DESIGN EXPERIENCE (I / II / III)

Project Report Format

Guidelines and Templates · common for all verticals and all semesters

1. Purpose and scope

This format applies to the project report (Final Technical Report / Portfolio) of Design Experience I, II and III, in all five verticals: VIP, EPICS, Industry Research, Technical Competition and Entrepreneurship. The report consolidates the evidence kept in the IER / Design Experience Portfolio and is evaluated at the Portfolio Review (Week 13) and the Final Evaluation / TEE (Week 15), where it carries 30 ICA marks.

- One project report is submitted per project team. Each student documents his/her own work in Chapter 5 (Individual Contribution, Teamwork and Reflection), because assessment is individual.
- Report the work done during the semester of registration. For a continuing project, summarise earlier work only as background and mark clearly what was done by earlier teams or semesters.
- The report must show the five competencies: individual contribution, design / development process, reflective and critical thinking, teamwork and leadership, and communication / documentation.
- Yellow-highlighted text in square brackets in the templates is to be replaced by the student.

2. Formatting specifications

Table 1: Page and text formatting

#	Item	Specification
1	Paper and font	A4; Times New Roman throughout.
2	Report text	Font size 12; line spacing 1.5.
3	Margins	Left 1.5″; top, bottom and right 1″ each.
4	Header	Left corner: Project Title. Right corner: Academic Year.
5	Footer	Right corner: Page number.
6	Chapter title	Font size 18, bold.
7	Section title	Font size 14, bold.
8	Subsection title	Font size 12, bold.
9	Figure caption	Below the figure; Times New Roman, font size 10.
10	Table caption	Above the table; Times New Roman, font size 10.
11	Page numbers	Front matter (lists of figures, tables, abbreviations): Roman numerals. From Chapter 1 onwards: decimal numbers.

#	Item	Specification
12	Chapter structure	Every chapter has an introduction paragraph and closing summary lines.
13	Conclusion	Only one conclusion, written at the end of the report (Chapter 6).
14	Appendices	Numbered in Roman capitals (Appendix I, Appendix II …).
15	Verification and submission	The report is verified and signed by the faculty mentor before the Portfolio Review / Final Evaluation. Hard-bound (black) or PDF copies as directed by the Design Experience coordinator.

3. Order of contents

Table 2: Sequence of the report

Part	Item	Page numbering	Remarks
Front matter	Title (cover) page	—	Template T1
	Certificate	—	Template T2; signed by mentor, vertical SPOC and HoD
	Acknowledgement, team details and declaration	Roman	Template T3
	Abstract	Roman	About one page: problem, approach, contribution and outcome
	Table of Contents; List of Figures; List of Tables; Abbreviations	Roman	Layout in Template T4
Main body	Chapter 1 Introduction	1, 2, 3 …	Chapter layout in Template T5
	Chapter 2 Background Study		
	Chapter 3 Design and Development Process		
	Chapter 4 Implementation, Results and Analysis		
	Chapter 5 Individual Contribution, Teamwork and Reflection		Specific to Design Experience
	Chapter 6 Conclusion and Future Scope		
End matter	References		Numbered IEEE style
	Appendices		Appendix I … as listed in Table 4

4. Chapter-wise content guide

Each chapter should open with a short introduction and end with summary lines. Competency codes: IA = Individual Accomplishments, DP = Design / Development Process, RC = Reflective & Critical Thinking, TL = Teamwork & Leadership, OC = Oral & Written Communication / Documentation.

Table 3: Contents of each chapter

Chapter	Sections and content	Competency evidenced
1 Introduction	1.1 Background of the project topic 1.2 Motivation and scope of the report 1.3 Problem statement / need, and stakeholders or users 1.4 Objectives and expected outcomes 1.5 Project context and continuity: earlier work vs work of this semester; vertical and partner, if any 1.6 Organization of the report	IA, OC
2 Background Study	2.1 Overview of the domain and its context 2.2 Review of relevant sources: journal / conference papers, standards, patents, existing products, reports, community or market studies (compare in a table; write in paragraph form) 2.3 Gap or need identified, leading to the problem definition	RC, DP
3 Design and Development Process	3.1 Stakeholder / user needs and specifications (requirements) 3.2 Design alternatives considered and the decision (decision matrix) with reasons 3.3 Selected design: block diagram, architecture, CAD, algorithm / flowchart, research methodology, community solution or MVP / business model 3.4 Standards, constraints, safety, ethical, societal and environmental considerations (cite IEEE or other standards followed) 3.5 Project plan: work breakdown, milestones, Gantt chart, task allocation	DP, RC
4 Implementation, Results and Analysis	4.1 Implementation: prototype, software, experiments, MVP, field work or competition build (with photographs and descriptions) 4.2 Testing, validation and verification: test plan, data, standards used to test validity 4.3 Results and analysis, with the student's own contribution brought out 4.4 Feedback received and iterations made 4.5 Advantages, limitations and applications / impact	IA, DP, RC

Chapter	Sections and content	Competency evidenced
5 Individual Contribution, Teamwork and Reflection	5.1 Team structure, roles and responsibilities 5.2 Individual contribution statement for every student: tasks owned, outputs produced and the Evidence IDs from the IER (contribution matrix) 5.3 Teamwork and leadership: meetings, coordination, conflict handling, stakeholder / partner interactions, summary of peer and mentor feedback 5.4 Reflection by each student: key decisions and reasons, challenges, lessons learned, plans for improvement 5.5 Project management, professional conduct and AI-use disclosure	IA, TL, RC
6 Conclusion and Future Scope	6.1 Brief report of the work carried out and conclusions drawn from the analysis in Chapter 4 6.2 Future scope and hand-over notes so that the project can continue smoothly in the next semester	RC, OC

References

Number all references; cite each in the text at the same number as in the list; list them in the order of citation (IEEE style). Every listed reference must be cited in the report.

Book: [1] A. B. Author, C. D. Author, Title of Book, edition, chapter, pp. xx–xx, Publisher, City, Year.

Journal / conference paper: [2] A. B. Author, C. D. Author, “Title of paper,” Name of Journal / Conference, vol. xx, no. x, pp. xx–xx, Month Year.

Standard / web source: [3] Issuing body, “Title of standard or page,” Standard number or URL, Year / date accessed.

Appendices

Table 4: Suggested appendices

Appendix	Content
Appendix I	Summary of the IER and Evidence Register (Evidence IDs, descriptions, locations)
Appendix II	Specifications of components, data sheets, pin diagrams, CAD drawings, flowcharts
Appendix III	Source code, sample codes, raw experimental / survey / test observations
Appendix IV	Meeting minutes, peer feedback forms and mentor feedback
Appendix V	Vertical-specific evidence (see Table 5)
Appendix VI	Publications, competition certificates, patent / IP filings (list of papers presented and published; reprints may be added)
Appendix VII	AI-tool use disclosure log (tool, purpose, how the output was verified)

5. Vertical-specific emphasis

The report structure and the five competencies are the same for all verticals. Only the type of evidence differs. Use Chapters 2 to 4 and Appendix V for the items below.

Table 5: Typical evidence by vertical

Vertical	Typical content to emphasise
VIP / Industry Research	Research gap, methodology, experiments or simulations, technical outputs, analysis of results, draft papers; for industry projects, partner requirements and (where applicable) confidentiality.
EPICS	Community partner and stakeholder needs, needs assessment, community stakeholder feedback, usability evaluation, social impact and sustainability of the solution.
Technical Competition	Competition problem and rules, design report, build and test records, budget, deliverables, participation and results.
Entrepreneurship	Customer discovery and problem validation, MVP, business model, market validation, financial plan.

6. Academic integrity, AI use and intellectual property

- The report must be the students' own work. Avoid plagiarism, acknowledge all contributors and sources, respect confidentiality and follow professional and safety requirements.
- AI tools may be used where permitted (for example for literature review, coding assistance, brainstorming, grammar and visualization). Every use is disclosed in Section 5.5 and Appendix VII, and AI-generated work must be verified by the student.
- Intellectual property created under Design Experience is governed by the IPR Policy of SVKM's NMIMS. Obtain the necessary approvals before any public disclosure of potentially patentable work.
- Publications arising from the project must acknowledge MPSTME, SVKM's NMIMS and all eligible contributors.

7. Submission checklist

✓	Item to confirm before submission	Mentor initials
☐	Cover page, certificate, acknowledgement / team details and declaration completed	
☐	Abstract is about one page; contents, lists of figures, tables and abbreviations included	
☐	Font, spacing, margins, headers, footers, caption positions and page numbering as per Table 1	
☐	All six chapters present; each has an introduction and summary lines; one conclusion at the end	
☐	Chapter 5 has the individual contribution and reflection of every team member, with Evidence IDs	
☐	References numbered, cited in the text and in IEEE style; standards followed are mentioned	
☐	Appendices I to VII included as applicable; AI-use disclosure completed	
☐	Similarity (plagiarism / AI) check done as per University practice	
☐	Report verified and signed by the faculty mentor before the Portfolio Review / Final Evaluation	

Templates

Templates T1 to T5 show the layout expected in the final report. Replace the highlighted text.

T1 Title (cover) page

[Project Title]

Design Experience [I / II / III] Project Report

submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements of

[Name of the Programme]

in

[Name of the Stream / Department]

Vertical: [VIP / EPICS / Industry Research / Technical Competition / Entrepreneurship]

by

[Name 1 (Roll No. / SAP ID)]
[Name 2 (Roll No. / SAP ID)]
[Name 3 (Roll No. / SAP ID)]

Under the supervision of

[Name of Faculty Mentor]
[Designation, Department, MPSTME]



MPSTME, SVKM's NMIMS (Deemed-to-be University), Mumbai
[Academic Year]

T2 Certificate

SVKM's NMIMS University

(Deemed-to-be University)



MUKESH PATEL SCHOOL OF TECHNOLOGY MANAGEMENT & ENGINEERING (MPSTME)

Vile Parle (W), Mumbai-56

[Academic Year]

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the Design Experience [I / II / III] project entitled "[Title]" has been carried out by [Names with Roll No.] under my guidance and supervision, and has been submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements of [Name of the Programme] in [Name of the Stream] of MPSTME, SVKM's NMIMS (Deemed-to-be University), Mumbai, India.

_____	_____	_____
Project mentor (name and signature) (Internal Guide)	Vertical SPOC (name and signature)	HoD (name and signature)

Date:

Place: Mumbai

T3 Acknowledgement, team details and declaration

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

[Thank the faculty mentor, vertical SPOC, industry / community / competition partners, funding or resource providers and peers. Mention the specific help received.]

Name	Roll No.	SAP ID
[Student 1]	[ ]	[ ]
[Student 2]	[ ]	[ ]
[Student 3]	[ ]	[ ]

DECLARATION

We declare that this report is our original work and reflects our own contribution in the semester of registration. We have acknowledged all contributors and cited all sources. The use of AI tools, if any, is disclosed in Section 5.5 and Appendix VII, and AI-generated content has been verified by us.

Signatures of students: _____ _____ _____ Date: _____

T4 Table of contents layout

Table of Contents

Abstract i

Table of Contents ii

List of Figures iii

List of Tables iv

Abbreviations v

Chapter 1 Introduction 1

1.1 Background of the project topic 1

1.2 Motivation and scope of the report 2

1.3 Problem statement / need 3

1.4 Objectives and expected outcomes 4

1.5 Project context and continuity 5

1.6 Organization of the report 6

Chapter 2 Background Study .....

Chapter 3 Design and Development Process .....

Chapter 4 Implementation, Results and Analysis .....

Chapter 5 Individual Contribution, Teamwork and Reflection .....

Chapter 6 Conclusion and Future Scope .....

References .....

Appendix I … Appendix VII .....

List of Figures and List of Tables use the columns: Fig. No. / Table No. | Name of the figure / table | Page No. Abbreviations are listed with their full forms.

T5 Chapter page layout

Chapter 1

Introduction

[Introduction paragraph: what this chapter covers and how it links to the project.]

1.1 Background of the project topic

1.1.1 [Subsection title]

[Report text in Times New Roman 12, line spacing 1.5. Cite each source by its number and list it in the References at the same number.]

Table 1.1: [Name of the table, placed above the table]

[Column 1]	[Column 2]	[Column 3]
[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
[ ]	[ ]	[ ]

[Figure / photograph / diagram]

Fig. 1.1: [Name of the figure, placed below the figure]

[Summary lines: close every chapter with a short summary of what was covered.]